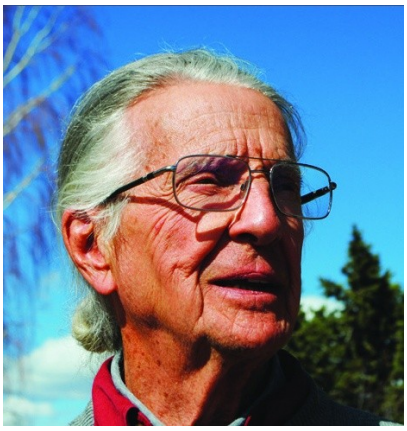
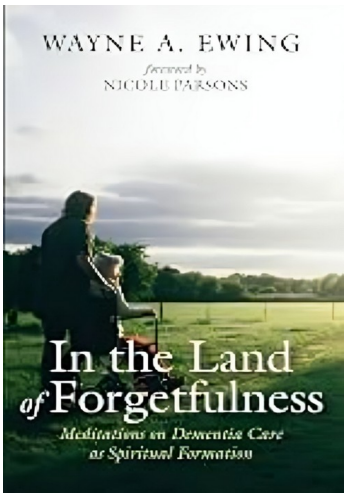
In the Land of Forgetfulness Readers Guide

by Wayne A. Ewing, PhD





1. What draws you to this book? Are or were you a caregiver, a professional, a spiritual seeker, or someone simply curious about the intersection of faith and suffering?

2. Before reading, what were your assumptions or fears about dementia caregiving? Has this book shifted any of those in any way?

3. Wayne challenges the idea that identity depends on memory. What do you believe makes a person who they are? Has your understanding shifted through your own experience with dementia?

4. Wayne speaks of moments of recognition and connection with Ann even as her memory faded. Have you experienced similar moments with someone you love? What did those moments teach you?

5. Had you ever considered that caregiving could be a form of spiritual formation before reading this book? How does Wayne make that case and how convincing do you find it?

6. Wayne speaks of finding grace, presence, and even God in the most exhausting and heartbreaking moments of caregiving. Does that resonate with your own experience, or does it feel difficult to accept?

7. Wayne draws on the language of contemplative and mystical traditions. Were there particular images, metaphors, or spiritual concepts in the book that especially moved or challenged you?

8. For readers who do not come from a faith

tradition, what in this book still speaks to your experience of caregiving or grief?

9. Wayne describes transforming finite resources into infinite ones through a shift in spiritual perspective. What does that mean to you practically in the context of daily caregiving?

10. Wayne is honest about the exhaustion, isolation, and grief that accompany caregiving. Did reading those honest admissions make you feel less alone? More understood?

11. How does Wayne hold together grief and gratitude throughout these meditations? Is that a tension you recognise in your own experience?

12. What has reading this book taught you about what cannot be forgotten? Is there someone in your life right now who needs it? How might you share it with them?

The Rev. Wayne A. Ewing, PhD served as the devoted 24/7 care partner of his late wife Ann through her five-year journey with Alzheimer's. He is a retired Episcopal priest, pastoral counselor, and academic, and continues to work as a staff writer for the award-winning Wet Mountain Tribune in Colorado. His companion volume, Tears in God's Bottle, won multiple awards including Second Place Book of the Year in Religion from Foreword Magazine, Finalist for the Benjamin Franklin Award, multiple GLYPH Awards, and the Clara Award. Both books are available on Amazon.

Web: www.waewing.com